

OPERATIONAL GOVERNANCE STACK

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA FRAMEWORK (OGSAM) v1

Measuring Governance Capability Through Structured Assessment Domains



LAYER & PURPOSE	ASSESSMENT DOMAINS	ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS (Score 1–5)	GOVERNANCE QUESTION	OUTCOME
LAYER 5 GOVERNANCE OVERSIGHT LAYER Strategy, oversight, and assurance at the highest organizational level.	- Governance Strategy - Governance Objectives - Governance Reporting - Board Oversight - Governance Metrics	- Are governance objectives clearly defined? - Is governance strategy documented and aligned to business strategy? - Are governance responsibilities established at the leadership level? - Are governance metrics defined and tracked? - Does leadership receive regular governance reporting? - Are governance decisions documented? - Are governance issues escalated appropriately?	Are governance objectives and oversight functioning effectively?	Strategic oversight and assurance.
LAYER 4 ACCOUNTABILITY LAYER Ownership, authority, and accountability for decisions and outcomes.	- Ownership - Decision Rights - Authority Structures - RACI Models - Escalation Paths - Accountability Mechanisms	- Is ownership clearly assigned for systems and outcomes? - Are decision rights documented? - Are responsibilities defined and communicated? - Are escalation paths documented? - Are accountability mechanisms in place? - Is segregation of duties maintained? - Is accountability measurable?	Who owns decisions, outcomes, and failures?	Clear accountability and authority.
LAYER 3 CONTROL LAYER Policies, guardrails, and controls that translate governance expectations into enforceable mechanisms.	- Policies - Operational Controls - Guardrails - Access Controls - Data Governance - Model Governance	- Are governance policies documented? - Are controls mapped to governance requirements? - Are preventive controls implemented? - Are detective controls implemented? - Are corrective controls implemented? - Are controls tested for effectiveness? - Do controls cover critical risks and systems?	How are governance expectations translated into enforceable operational controls?	Consistent and enforceable controls.
LAYER 2 RUNTIME GOVERNANCE LAYER Monitoring, intervention, and governance during real-time system operation.	- Runtime Monitoring - Runtime Enforcement - Human Intervention - Escalation Mechanisms - Incident Response - Containment & Recovery	- Is runtime monitoring implemented? - Can governance policies be enforced at runtime? - Can human intervention override actions? - Are escalation mechanisms available? - Are incidents detected and escalated? - Are incident response procedures in place? - Can systems be contained or paused? - Are recovery procedures tested?	Does governance remain operational after deployment?	Real-time governance capability and resilience.
LAYER 1 EVIDENCE LAYER Logging, audit trails, and evidence to demonstrate and prove governance activities.	- Logging - Audit Trails - Traceability - Reporting - Metrics - Record Retention	- Are governance activities logged? - Are audit trails complete and immutable? - Can decisions be traced to approvals? - Are governance KPIs measured? - Are governance reports generated? - Is evidence retained per policy? - Can evidence be produced on demand?	Can governance activities be measured, verified, and defended?	Verifiable governance evidence.

GOVERNANCE MATURITY SCALE (1–5)					SCORING MODEL (EXAMPLE)			GOVERNANCE HEAT MAP	
1 AD HOC Governance is informal, inconsistent, and dependent on individual effort.	2 DOCUMENTED Governance expectations are documented but not consistently applied.	3 IMPLEMENTED Governance processes are consistently executed and operational.	4 MEASURED Governance effectiveness is measured and performance is managed.	5 OPTIMIZED Governance is embedded, adaptive, and continuously improving.	LAYER	SCORE (1–5)	RATING	LAYER	RATING
					5 Governance Oversight Layer	4.2		5 Governance Oversight Layer	Strong
					4 Accountability Layer	3.6		4 Accountability Layer	Moderate
					3 Control Layer	4.0		3 Control Layer	Strong
					2 Runtime Governance Layer	2.1		2 Runtime Governance Layer	Weak
					1 Evidence Layer	4.3		1 Evidence Layer	Strong
					OVERALL OGSAM SCORE	3.64	LEVEL 3 IMPLEMENTED		

ASSESSMENT OUTPUTS				
GOVERNANCE MATURITY RATING Overall governance capability score.	GOVERNANCE HEAT MAP Visual representation of strengths and weaknesses.	GOVERNANCE GAP ANALYSIS Identification of capability gaps across layers.	GOVERNANCE IMPROVEMENT ROADMAP Prioritized improvement actions with clear next steps.	EXECUTIVE GOVERNANCE SUMMARY Board and leadership reporting package.

GERALD ON GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLE

Governance maturity is not determined by the existence of policies, committees, or documentation. Governance maturity is determined by the organization’s ability to establish oversight, assign accountability, enforce controls, govern at runtime, and produce evidence that governance actually occurred.

Gerald.

GERALD ON GOVERNANCE

Turning AI Governance Principles into Operational Reality.

GOVERNANCE THAT OPERATES. TRUST THAT SCALES.